

Chapter 2: Social Learning & Social Cognition

Sources of Social Knowledge

How We Use Our Expectations

Sources of Social Knowledge

Learning

conditioning

Operant conditioning

AKA instrumental conditioning

Classical conditioning

AKA respondent conditioning

Classically Conditioning a Salivation Response

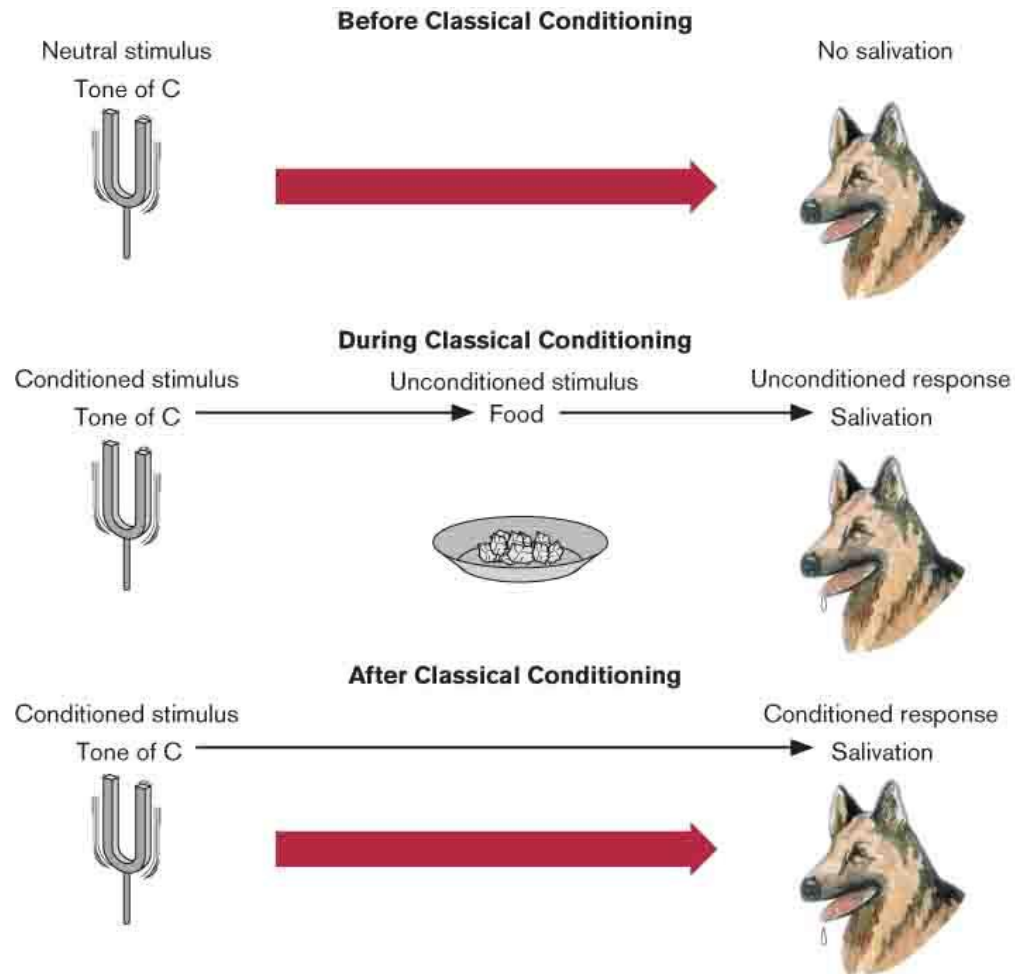


FIGURE 5.2

Classically Conditioning a Salivation Response

A neutral stimulus (a tone) elicits no salivation until it is repeatedly paired with the unconditioned stimulus (food). After many pairings, the neutral stimulus (now called *conditioned stimulus*) alone produces salivation. Classical conditioning has occurred.

Generalization in Classical Conditioning

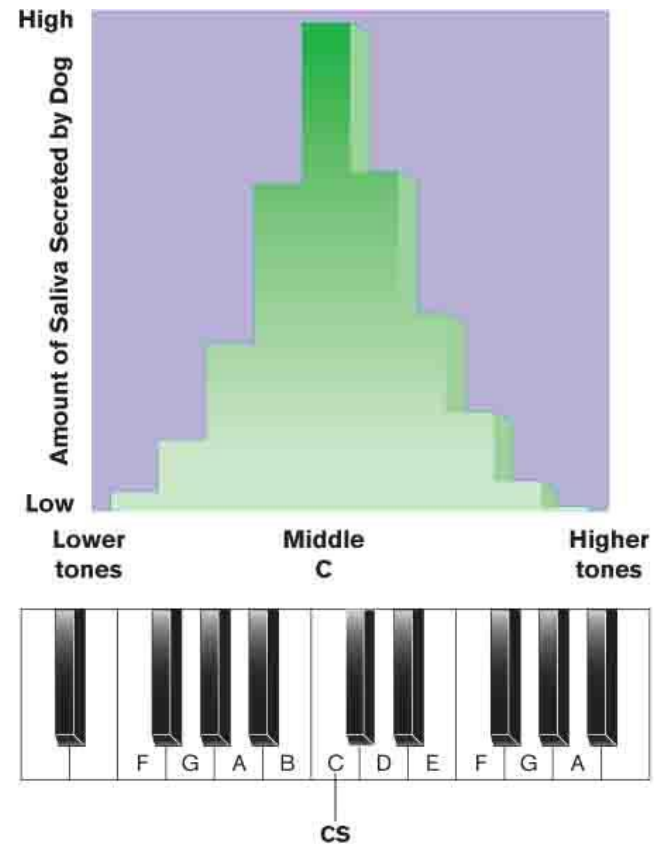


FIGURE 5.4

Generalization in Classical Conditioning

Because of the phenomenon of generalization, a dog conditioned to salivate to middle C (the CS) on the piano also salivates to similar tones—but less and less so as the tone moves away from middle C.

Positive and Negative Reinforcement

Positive Reinforcement

- Pleasant or desirable consequence.
- Increases probability of response occurring again if applied after response.

Negative Reinforcement

- Behaviour likely to occur again because followed by termination of aversive condition.

Punishment

Punishment

- Addition of unpleasant stimulus or removal of pleasant stimulus.

Unpleasant Stimulus

- Scolding, criticism, prison sentence, pain.

Removal of a Pleasant Stimulus

- Withholding affection and attention.
- Taking away privilege, suspending driver's license.

Sources of Social Knowledge

Operant learning

Associational learning

Observational learning
modeling

Sources of Social Knowledge

Schemas

Accommodation

Assimilation

The Nature of Remembering

Schemas

- Framework of knowledge and assumptions about people, objects, events can affect encoding and information recall.
- **Accommodation** is a process of adaptation by which the pre-existing schema is altered in order to fit in the new knowledge. In
- **Assimilation**, the schema is not changed, it is only modified. In Accommodation, the schema is altered; a new schema may be developed.

Sources of Social Knowledge

- **Confirmation bias:** the tendency for people to favor information that confirms their expectations, regardless of whether the information is true.
- **Self-fulfilling prophecy** a process that occurs when our expectations about others lead us to behave toward those others in ways that make those expectations come true.

How We Use Our Expectations

Automatic cognition: thinking that occurs out of our awareness, quickly, and without taking much effort

Controlled cognition: When we deliberately size up and think about something—for instance another person

Priming: A technique in which information is temporarily brought into memory through exposure to situational events—and that shows that priming can influence judgments entirely out of awareness

Cognitive Process	Description	Example
Cognitive accessibility	Some schemas and attitudes are more accessible than others.	We may think a lot about our new haircut because it is important to us.
Salience	Some stimuli, such as those that are unusual, colorful, or moving, grab our attention.	We may base our judgments on a single unusual event and ignore hundreds of other events that are more usual.
Representativeness heuristic	We tend to make judgments according to how well the event matches our expectations.	After a coin has come up heads many times in a row, we may erroneously think that the next flip is more likely to be tails.
Availability heuristic	Things that come to mind easily tend to be seen as more common.	We may overestimate the crime statistics in our own area because these crimes are so easy to recall.
Anchoring and adjustment	Although we try to adjust our judgments away from them, our decisions are overly based on the things that are most highly accessible in memory.	We may buy more of a product when it is advertised in bulk than when it is advertised as a single item.
Counterfactual thinking	We may “replay” events such that they turn out differently—especially when only minor changes in the events leading up to them make a difference.	We may feel particularly bad about events that might not have occurred if only a small change might have prevented them.
False consensus bias	We tend to see other people as similar to us.	We are surprised when other people have different political opinions or values.
Overconfidence	We tend to have more confidence in our skills, abilities, and judgments than is objectively warranted.	Eyewitnesses are often extremely confident that their identifications are accurate, even when they are not.